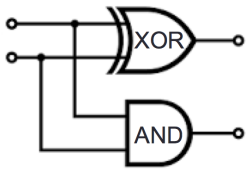
Half adder circuit

Fixed-width addition: adding one bit at time, using the usual column-by-column and carry arithmetic, and dropping the carry from the leftmost column so the result is the same width as the summands. In many cases, this gives representation of the correct value for the sum when we interpret the summands in fixed-width binary or in 2s complement.

Addition: For single column:

Input		Output	
x_0	y_0	c_0	s_0
1	1		
1	0		
0	1		
0	0		



CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version October 21, 2026 (1)

Two bit adder circuit

Draw a logic circuit that implements binary addition of two numbers that are each represented in fixed-width binary:

- Inputs x_0, y_0, x_1, y_1 represent $(x_1 x_0)_{2,2}$ and $(y_1 y_0)_{2,2}$
- Outputs z_0, z_1, z_2 represent $(z_2 z_1 z_0)_{2,3} = (x_1 x_0)_{2,2} + (y_1 y_0)_{2,2}$ (may require up to width 3)

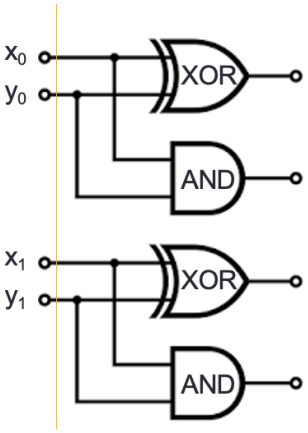
First approach: half-adder for each column, then combine carry from right column with sum of left column

Write expressions for the circuit output values in terms of input values:

$z_0 =$ _____

$z_1 =$ _____

$z_2 =$ _____



There are other approaches, for example: for middle column, first add carry from right column to x_1, then add result to y_1

Extra practice: how does this circuit change if we're representing fixed-width addition?

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version October 21, 2026 (2)

Fixed width definition

Definition For b an integer greater than 1, w a positive integer, and n a nonnegative integer _____, the **base b fixed-width w expansion of n** is

$$(a_{w-1} \cdots a_1 a_0)_{b,w}$$

where $a_0, a_1, \ldots, a_{w-1}$ are nonnegative integers less than b and

$$n = \sum_{i=0}^{w-1} a_i b^i$$

Representing zero

Representing 0: Which of the representations so far allow us to represent 0?

CC BY-NC-SA 2.0 Version October 21, 2026 (3)